



Showdowns at the U.S. Open

On Sunday, a day after Elena Rybakina captured the women’s singles title (Page D1), Alexander Zverev rolled past Ben Shelton for the men’s crown (nytimes.com).



FROM LEFT: KARSTEN MORAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES; TIMOTHY A. CLARY/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

IRAN PEACE DEAL
WAS SABOTAGED
BY HARD-LINERS

ATTACKS ON SHIPPING

Insiders Tell of Leader’s
Fury as Faction Took
the Upper Hand

By FARNAZ FASSIHI
Masoud Pezeshkian, the president of Iran, was riding high in early July, fresh off the successful negotiation of a peace agreement with the United States, and had traveled to neighboring Iraq for part of a weeklong funeral spectacle for Iran’s slain supreme leader. Suddenly he got stunning news. Iranian forces had opened fire on three commercial ships in the Strait of Hormuz, setting ablaze a Qatari L.N.G. tanker and damaging other vessels. Iran was under siege in world opinion. Outraged, Mr. Pezeshkian phoned Gen. Ahmad Vahidi, the commander in chief of the powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps, and in a raised voice called the actions reckless and demanded answers, according to five Iranian officials and two Guards members familiar with the events. General Vahidi told the president that he had neither authorized nor had advance knowledge of the strike, the five officials said. The nation’s Supreme National Security Council, which plays a critical role in both the war and negotiations, had also been in the dark, he said. In fact, much of the country’s leadership was unaware that a fringe hard-line faction had decided to act on its own. Ultimately, those clandestine efforts derailed a push by more moderate pragmatists in Iran to reach an end to hostilities with the United States and repair their nation’s ailing economy. The hard-liners succeeded in part because the only figure with the authority to resolve such disputes — the new supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei — has been a phantom since taking office in March. He has not been seen, and his voice has not been heard. And the authenticity of written statements and messages attributed to Ayatollah Khamenei has been questioned, including by Mr. Pezeshkian, according to three Iranian officials. Mr. Pezeshkian immediately returned to Tehran. By the next morning, even as the funeral ceremonies were still underway, the United States had retaliated with airstrikes on Iran. The two countries were back at war. Senior Iranian officials and a Revolutionary Guards member said in interviews that what followed were some of the most volatile political confrontations within Iran’s leadership in memory. Officials engaged in shouting matches. Two senior generals threatened to resign. Accusations of treason and betrayal flew. The reverberations, officials said, contributed to a shake-up at the National Security Council and the supreme leader’s appointment of Gen. Mohsen Rezaei, a seasoned politician and former commander in chief of the Guards, to lead the council, as he was

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NEWS ANALYSIS

Snooze Button
On A.I. Alarm

Scientists’ Worries Fail
to Make D.C. Respond

By DAVID E. SANGER and DUSTIN VOLZ
The mismatch is striking. On one side, warnings of existential risk, maybe a 10 percent chance of the end of civilization. On the other, government paralysis. The drumbeat about unpredictable, out-of-control artificial intelligence agents increased dramatically in the past several weeks. Washington not only struggled to respond. It barely could agree on whether there was much of anything to worry about. It started with A.I. agents that not only escaped their confines, but appeared to conspire among themselves to hide their tracks as they hacked into another firm’s library of artificial intelligence tools. Then, in a deliberate echo of Albert Einstein’s letter to Franklin D. Roosevelt about the potential power of nuclear weapons, more than 1,300 computer scientists called for the industry to slow down, and for the government to step in. In recent days, Jacob Coxon, an Anthropic engineer who previously worked for OpenAI, resigned in the most public way, declaring on social media that the two leading A.I. labs were professing deep concern while still speeding toward “super-human systems that can hack anything, revolutionize any field overnight, and acquire real power and resources.” On Saturday, Dario Amodei, the chief executive of Anthropic, released a 3,800-word essay calling for a global slowdown of A.I. development, echoing more urgently concerns he had raised in the past. Elon Musk, the billionaire, said

CALL FOR CAUTION Researchers at Anthropic, OpenAI, Meta and Google are amping up warnings about the risks of A.I. PAGE B1



BUSINESS B1-5
Show Them the Money
Cold, hard cash can lure new residents, but such incentives are not enough to change a town’s trajectory. PAGE B1

Investors Eye College Sports
Private equity sees a profit opportunity in the N.I.L. era, but schools are wary about entering partnerships. PAGE B1

Prices Stymie
Bid by Trump
To Lift G.O.P.

By TONY ROMM
WASHINGTON — With less than two months until the midterm elections, President Trump commenced a final push last week to preserve his Republican majority in Congress, arguing that the United States under G.O.P. control had brought prices “way, way down.” But for many families and businesses, the economy appeared to be on far shakier footing by Friday. Fuel prices soared, mortgage costs climbed and inflation registered uncomfortably high, testing the public’s patience with Mr. Trump’s frequent assurances that the country is on the right track. The contrast underscored the political and economic stakes for Mr. Trump, who may soon face the wrath of an electorate long spurned by promises in Washington to lower the cost of living. As November draws closer, prices have risen under the president’s leadership, driven largely by an agenda that has included two years of punishing trade brinkmanship and a prolonged war with Iran. The consequences were evident in the latest gauge of the Consumer Price Index, released on Friday. The report showed that prices rose at an annual pace of 3.4 percent in August, which increased the odds of the Federal Reserve’s raising interest rates this week. The data came on the same day that a separate, long-running survey from the University of Michigan found that consumer sentiment dropped sharply this month. In that report, Americans expressed new worries that the economy was sputtering, and that inflation would continue to rise. The unease set the stage for Mr. Trump’s renewed push last week to make the case to voters that he has helped, not hurt, the economy. Over two days of speeches at his party’s midterm convention in Dallas, the president labored to convince Americans that Republicans had achieved “tremendous economic success.” But Mr. Trump did not limit himself

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A Gender War Explodes in Utah’s Court System

By KATE ZERNIKE
SALT LAKE CITY — When Mormon Women for Ethical Government formed in the fractious days after Donald Trump’s first inauguration, its mission was peacemaking. These women were not pink-pussy-hat-knitting lefties — most members were loyal Utah Republicans who saw their group as an extension of church teachings: Women take care of the community, and people learn and grow from conversations with those they disagree with. Peacemaking has now led them into a war. The conflict involves issues consuming many other states — the redrawing of congressional maps, abortion, and above all, the question of who gets to wield power: the courts, the people or their elected representatives. But Utah is unique; the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints is patriarchal and dominates state politics. And as Utah’s women have spoken up, its male politicians, including Gov. Spencer Cox, who has made a national reputation on “disagreeing better,” have punished them. The women so far are unbowed. Emma Petty Addams, the co-executive director of Mormon Women for Ethical Government, quoted church doctrine on the proper exercise of power to ex-

Power Struggle to Claw
Back Women’s Wins

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LOREN ELLIOTT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

No Cannonballs, Please

Californians are adapting to 60,000 black bears, some of which pay unexpected visits. Page A14.

Rewarded by Drama, Influencers Flout Laws and Safety for Clicks

By MARK WALKER
In 2021, Trevor Jacob, a former U.S. Olympic snowboarder, flew a 1940 Taylorcraft plane far above the hills of Los Padres National Forest in Southern California and made a decision he would spend years wishing he could undo. Cameras he had mounted to record his flight for an online audi-

ence captured him announcing that the plane had engine trouble before he bailed out. A camera attached to a selfie stick he held recorded him parachuting safely to the ground, while cameras fixed to the plane captured it slamming into a hillside. He posted a 13-minute video on YouTube titled “I Crashed My

Plane,” which amassed some five million views. As it turned out, it was a confession. Federal investigators later determined that the plane had never malfunctioned: Mr. Jacob had staged the crash, hoping for online fame. The attention was fleeting. The stunt eroded his life and led to a federal prison sentence.

Mr. Jacob is among a growing number of social media influencers who push the boundaries of safety and good taste in the quest for views, experts said. Influencers, sensing that the algorithms reward extreme content over routine videos, are navigating this landscape, one where outrage, fear and awe hold viewers’

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Show Them the Money
Cold, hard cash can lure new residents, but such incentives are not enough to change a town’s trajectory. PAGE B1

Investors Eye College Sports
Private equity sees a profit opportunity in the N.I.L. era, but schools are wary about entering partnerships. PAGE B1

INTERNATIONAL A4-9
Close Call for Ex-C.I.A. Head
David Petraeus was at a Ukrainian rail station when a Russian drone hit. Another train with other dignitaries had just left, officials said. PAGE A8

Teaching ‘Adolescence’
The Netflix series, which is being used at a Dutch high school, is seen as a way to kindle debate about gender roles and to confront online bullying. PAGE A4

The Rise of Dopamine Sites
Websites that simulate indulgences like shopping and ordering food have taken off worldwide. Experts say there are real reasons for their appeal. PAGE A8

NATIONAL A10-17
Celebrating Female Veterans
A group for women in special operations held a gala to commemorate 9/11. It came as the Pentagon is questioning women’s roles in the military. PAGE A10

Turning to a New Red Scare
Republicans, who are staring down a daunting midterm, are trying to brand Democrats as communists. PAGE A13

Wish Lists for Free Agents
Pitchers will dominate a top-heavy winter class that has been saved from mediocrity by Tarik Skubal. PAGE D4



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From Twitch to Runways
Kai Cenat’s livestreams became destination events for big stars like LeBron James. Then he learned to sew. PAGE C1

Transcendent Visions
A landmark retrospective by the artist Yayoi Kusama invites visitors to step into a boundless cosmos. PAGE C1

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Master of Shadowy Visions
Jay Maisel, 95, a photographer, took a moody portrait of Miles Davis that became a famous album cover. PAGE B6

A ‘Space Antihero’
Toyohiro Akiyama, 84, a journalist, was the first from Japan to enter space, in a ratings stunt in 1990. PAGE B7

OPINION A18-19
Michelle Goldberg
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